



△ CROWNING GLORY

A simple metal cross stands on top of the main tower of the cathedral. The cross was blessed by Pope Paul VI, who also donated the main altar and altarpiece in 1967.

◁ ANGELS IN FLIGHT

The three angels in flight over the nave, supported by steel cables, weigh 220–660 lb (100–300 kg) each and were designed by Alfredo Ceschiatti.

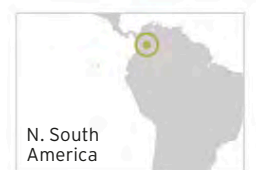


△ CENTRAL FIGURE

At the center of the main vault is a marble sculpture by Colombian artist Carlos Enrique Rodríguez based on Michelangelo's *The Creation of Adam*, a fresco in the Sistine Chapel ceiling.

Salt Cathedral of Zipaquirá

A cathedral of salt 660 ft (200 m) below ground that inspires and awes



When the Prussian naturalist Alexander von Humboldt (1769–1859) visited Colombia in 1801, he believed that the deposits of halite (rock salt) mined at Zipaquirá were larger than any of the mines found in Europe.

The mines had been exploited for centuries, during which time miners had carved sanctuaries where they prayed for protection in their dangerous labor. In the 1930s, they had excavated an underground church, and in 1950

began to turn this church into a salt cathedral, dedicated to Our Lady of Rosary, the patron saint of miners.

Structural and safety problems led to the cathedral's closure in 1992, but in response, the miners built a new cathedral 197 ft (61 m) below the old one. Inaugurated on December 16, 1995, the cathedral has three naves and 14 small chapels for each Station of the Cross, their icons and architectural details carved out of the halite rock.

Up to **3,000 visitors** come to **worship** at the Salt Cathedral **every Sunday**